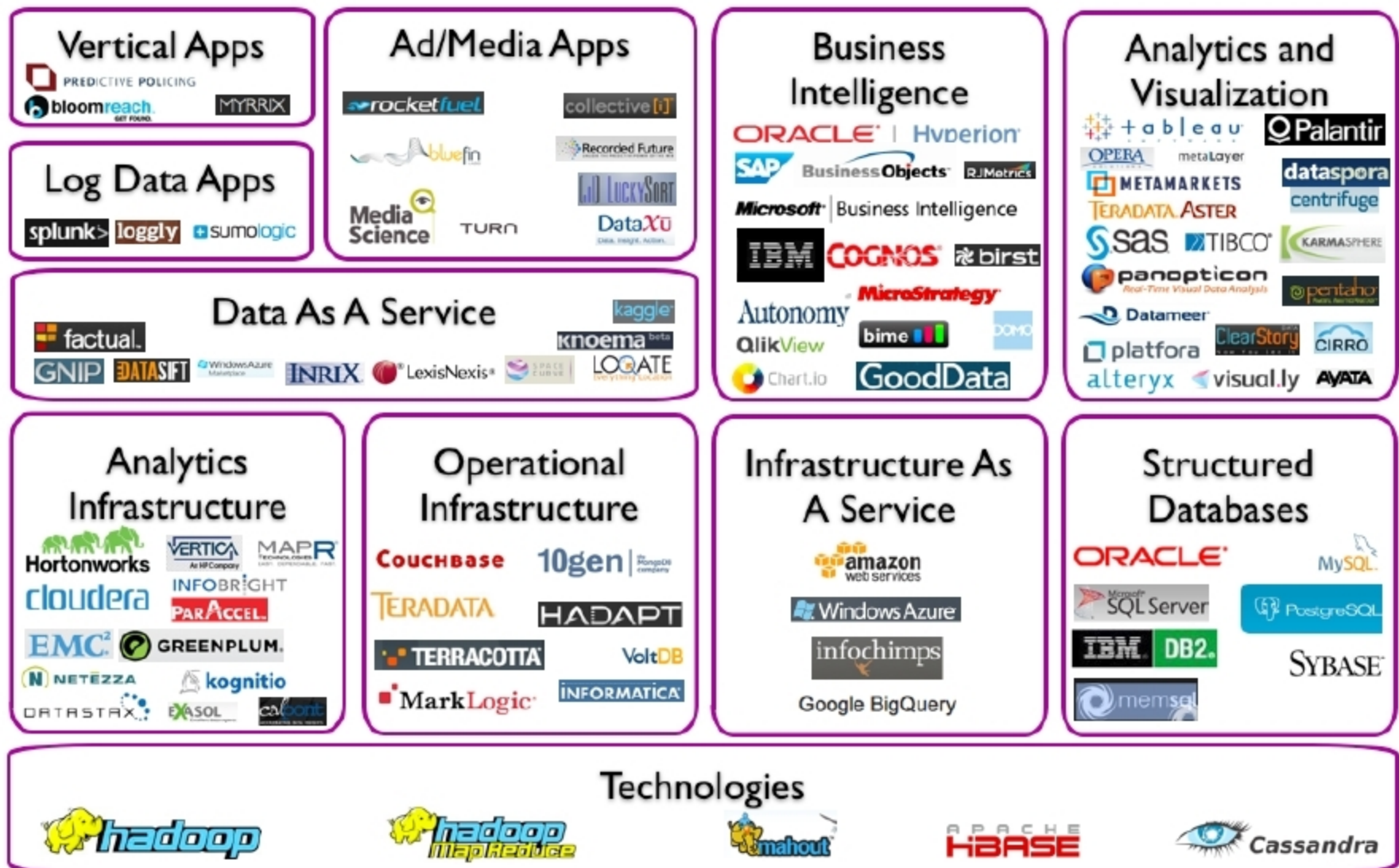


Big Data Landscape



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Figure 2: A crowded landscape to follow (Source: Forbes)

purportedly creating a data fabric that the promoters expect will serve as a foundational layer to run analytics on top of. It is interesting to follow recent developments in this burgeoning space as we see competitors enter the market and attempt to carve a niche for themselves with their product offerings.

Big Data analytics in the cloud

Apache Hadoop remains the popular choice for many organisations. However, many successors have emerged to offer a set of additional analytical capabilities: Apache Spark, commonly hailed as an improvement to the Hadoop ecosystem; Apache Storm that offers real-time data processing capabilities; and Google's BigQuery, which is supposedly a full-fledged platform for Big Data analytics.

Typically, cloud providers such as Amazon Web Services and Google Cloud Platform tend to build in-house products leveraging these capabilities, or replicate them entirely and offer them as hosted services to businesses. This helps them provide enterprise offerings that are closely integrated within their respective cloud computing ecosystem. There has been some discussion about the moral consequences of replicating open source products to profit off closed source versions of the same, but there has been no consensus on the topic, nor any severe consequences suffered on account of this questionable approach to boost revenue.

Another hosted service offering a plethora of Big Data analytics tools is Cloudera which has an established track record in the market. It has been making waves since its merger with Hortonworks earlier this year, giving it added fuel to compete with the giants in its bid to become the leading enterprise cloud provider in the market.

Overall, we've seen interesting developments in the Big Data storage and analysis domain and as the volume and variety of data grows, so do the opportunities to innovate in the field. **END** 🐧

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